

SUSE partners with Xamarin

SUSE has announced a deal with Xamarin to bring products to market faster and to more effectively support customers using Mono-based devices. The agreement grants Xamarin a broad, perpetual licence to all intellectual property covering Mono, MonoTouch, Mono for Android and Mono Tools for Visual Studio. Xamarin will also provide technical support to SUSE customers using Mono-based products, and assume stewardship of the Mono open source community project.

Mono is a software platform designed to allow developers to easily create cross-platform applications. It helps developers leverage a .NET ecosystem of code, libraries and tools to develop or port applications to non-Windows platforms, including Linux, Mac OS X, Apple iOS and Google Android. This agreement allows Xamarin to accelerate product commercialisation, and more rapidly bring to market next-generation, cross-platform mobile application development tools based on Mono.

Eclipse Foundation creates new open source initiative

The Eclipse Foundation has announced the formation of the Automotive Industry Working Group, with an aim to create a standard platform for the automotive industry's software development tools, based on Eclipse. German car maker, BMW Group, the automotive suppliers Robert Bosch GmbH and Continental AG, and the Eclipse Strategic Member itemis AG from Lünen, Germany are founding members of the open source initiative.

The new Eclipse Automotive Industry Working Group will be open to any organisation that wants to participate in the effort to establish a standard tools platform that will be used throughout the automotive supply chain.

It will operate under the Eclipse Foundation, an open source foundation that specialises in software development tools and runtime. Eclipse Industry Working Groups allow organisations to collaborate on the development of new technology. The results of the working group will be made available under the Eclipse Public License (EPL), a commercial-friendly open source licence.

Firefox Developer to join Chrome Browser Team

John Barton, the lead programmer of the Firefox Web development add-on, Firebug, is joining the Chrome browser team at Google after withdrawing from development work on the integrated Web development tool for Firefox. "Consequently I will no longer be contributing routinely to the development and maintenance of Firebug for Firefox," Barton said in a message to the Firebug Working Group.

He also mentioned that he was taking this step as he had been unable to convince IBM, his previous employer, to support him for a further year. At Google, Barton will be working on tools for Web developers, including implementation of the QueryPoint debugger. The move reflects the new rules of the browser market where Chrome has started replacing Firefox to hold a central place.



Canonical to change Ubuntu Certification Programme

Canonical plans to change its commercial certification programme—where manufacturers (OEMs and ODMs) can apply for their systems to be validated and endorsed to work with Ubuntu—in order to make it simpler for consumers to understand. Previously, the non-profit organisation offered two levels of endorsement for systems—'Ubuntu Certified' and 'Ubuntu Ready'.

While 'Ubuntu Certified' indicated that the UK-based Ubuntu sponsor would provide security and stability updates over the lifetime of an Ubuntu release for the certified system, 'Ubuntu Ready' was only an endorsement by Canonical at a specific point in time, thereby offering no guarantee over future release updates.

Recognising that the difference between these endorsement levels is perhaps not obvious to consumers, Canonical will be closing down the 'Ubuntu Ready' programme before the release of Ubuntu 11.10 in October.

Mandriva joins CompatibleOne consortium

French Linux provider Mandriva has joined the industry consortium CompatibleOne—a research project working on the development of a free cloud infrastructure using open standards and interoperable open source technologies, under the aegis of the two competitive clusters System@tic and SCS.

Sources in Mandriva said its R&D team will be working in three areas: the interoperability of virtualisation technologies, modelling of infrastructure resources, interoperability of resource management solutions, and management of virtual networks.

